

Dispatch AI to the work.

Thesis: Run internal AI enablement like a field-service operation: capture friction, triage value and risk, dispatch the smallest useful intervention, verify it in real work, and reroute based on evidence.

1. ACTUAL MANDATE

Stand up a one-person internal AI enablement function for ServiceLink that can assess readiness, build literacy, discover and prioritize cross-functional use cases, deliver practical AI solutions, govern use, coordinate boundaries with R&D and IT, build departmental champions, and report adoption, blockers, opportunities, and outcomes directly to the EVP.

2. WHY THE MANDATE IS DIFFICULT

Breadth vs bandwidth

The role serves multiple departments without direct reports. A visible queue and champion system are required to create leverage.

Quick wins vs durable change

Early proof builds trust, but novelty is not adoption. The system must measure retained behavior and workflow outcomes.

Speed vs governance

Approved tools, data handling, human authority, and escalation need to be clear enough for everyday work.

Builder vs influencer

The lead must ship useful solutions while transferring ownership to department leaders, users, and champions.

Enablement vs shadow IT/R&D

Some requests should be built locally; others must be escalated to the accountable technical or product owner.

Demand vs value

AI interest will exceed capacity. Prioritization must make tradeoffs explicit and defensible.

3. ROLE BOUNDARIES

R&D	AI Enablement Lead	IT
Customer-facing AI/ML product roadmap and product-development decisions.	Business workflow adoption, readiness, literacy, use cases, backlog, business cases, hands-on solutions, governance, champions, measurement, iteration.	Infrastructure, platform, architecture, identity, access, and enterprise technology decisions.

Five routes, one visible queue.

4. THE DISPATCH DECISION SYSTEM

Route	Use when	Examples	Primary proof
Enable	The blocker is literacy, confidence, examples, or policy clarity.	Role-specific workshops, playbooks, office hours, champion coaching.	Task adoption, confidence, repeat behavior.
Assist	The worker needs faster context, drafting, retrieval, summarization, or review support.	Copilots, prompts, templates, knowledge retrieval, structured review aids.	Cycle time, quality, downstream review effort.
Automate	The work contains stable repeatable rules, routing, classification, notifications, or data movement.	Low-code workflows, task orchestration, classification, routing, alerts.	Queue age, touch time, error, exception rate.
Build + Integrate	Value justifies a bot, internal tool, script, API, or deeper workflow integration.	Internal assistants, lightweight apps, integrations, bounded agents.	Workflow outcome, adoption, reliability, support burden.
Escalate	The request belongs to product roadmap, infrastructure, architecture, identity/access, or high-risk policy ownership.	R&D, IT, policy owner, security, or stop decision.	Clear ownership and reduced shadow delivery.

5. INTAKE AND PRIORITIZATION

Value

What business outcome or workflow friction changes, and how will we know?

Feasibility

Can the intervention be delivered with current tools, skills, data, and access?

Data + trust

What information is used, what is sensitive, and where must human authority remain?

Adoption burden

How much behavior, role, process, or manager support must change?

Owner strength

Is there a department leader and workflow owner prepared to sustain the change?

Reuse

Is the value local, or can a successful pattern help another workflow or department?

6. EVP SCORECARD

Dimension	Question
Demand quality	Are incoming requests becoming well-framed opportunities with owner, baseline, route, and measure?
Flow	How quickly do qualified use cases reach bounded field tests?
Adoption	Are people repeating the new behavior after launch?
Value	Did the workflow improve on its own relevant metric?
Trust	Are approved tools, data rules, human authority, and escalation paths explicit?
Learning	How quickly does evidence change the solution, training, route, or stop decision?

Operate close to the work.

7. PROOF MAP

Evidence	Transfer to ServiceLink mandate
Vape-Jet	Current AI-first operating transformation across multiple business functions and systems; connects factory, field, customer, machine-fleet, and support signals to prioritized work, standard work, training, dashboards, and accountability.
DudeWorth	AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks; value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value; agentic workflow patterns with human judgment and governance rails.
Amazon	24/7 operating cadence, launch discipline, standard work, visibility, escalation, labor planning, and customer-backward execution.
Compunetics	R&D-to-operations translation, engineering/manufacturing/quality leadership, technical communication, process controls, root cause, and high-reliability execution.
Cardinal + ZeusVu	Distributed operations, logistics and route-planning concepts, regulated field operations, GIS/mapping, and technology-risk-stakeholder coordination.

8. HARD OBJECTION

“Will a current Director of Operations thrive as a hands-on IC with no direct reports?”

Response: The strongest through-line is mechanism-building, not hierarchy: observe the workflow, make the problem visible, build or shape the intervention, connect technical and business people, teach the new standard, instrument the result, and iterate. Position the lack of a team as a reason to build leverage through a queue, champions, standards, reusable interventions, and explicit boundaries—not as a gap to hide.

9. FIRST 90 DAYS

0–30 · Map	31–60 · Dispatch	61–90 · Close the loop
Readiness interviews; workflow observation; current AI usage and policy inventory; intake and scoring; baseline measures; champion candidates.	Small cross-functional set of bounded field tests; live-workflow training; approved-use and data-handling guidance; EVP queue and outcome reporting.	Retire/reroute/iterate weak experiments; champion cadence; backlog review; R&D/IT escalation paths; retained adoption measures; next-quarter portfolio and capacity tradeoffs.

10. EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

1. What does unequivocal first-year success look like to the EVP?
2. Where is AI already being used informally, and where is risk or adoption friction highest?
3. What are the current approved-tool and data-handling boundaries?
4. When should this role build, and when should work move to IT or R&D?
5. Which workflows are already painful enough that leaders are asking for help?
6. What made prior cross-functional change stick—or fade?

SOURCES

Role scope: ServiceLink / Harris AI Enablement Lead JD supplied by candidate, requisition R0044690. Company context: Harris Solutions; Harris Year-In-Review: Looking Back on 2025; Harris home page. Candidate evidence: RoleForge candidate-evidence.yaml.